

LG G2

LG set to reveal its new flagship, the G2, on Aug 7 in New York; drops the Optimus tag



Man arrested for BitCoin scam

US regulators have charged a Texas man for running a Bitcoin scam in which he raised some \$4.5mn in the virtual currency. <http://goo.gl/YPgLL8>

Z87 Motherboards Test

on the latter. Although the SATA ports point upwards, the only consolation is that they are located behind the DIMM slots so the HDD SATA cables will not interfere with longer graphics card.

ASUS had two interesting micro ATX boards – Z87 Gryphon and Maximus VI Gene. The Z87 Gryphon is the first TUF series board in the microATX form factor. The visual DNA is very similar to its elder sibling, the Z87 Sabertooth board – brown coloured PCIe and memory slots, intricately designed heatsinks and absence of any on-board buttons. The Gryphon board does not come bundled in with the Thermal armour that has come to represent Sabertooth boards since the last couple of generations. But you do get the option to buy the Gryphon Armour kit which is sold separately which has the thermal armour and all the PCIe slot covers, port protec-



Gigabyte Z87M-D3H

tion pads and thermal sensor probes among other things. the board has three thermal sensor pins which give temperatures on the graphics card, HDD/SSD and CPU.

Finally we have the ASUS Maximus VI Gene which is a ROG board in a microATX form factor. The Gene series of boards has been a good value propo-

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ASRock	Mediaman Infotech	022 - 43441111	sales@mediaman.co.in	mediaman.co.in
Asus	ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.	18002090365	reachus@asus.com	asus.in
BIOSTAR	ABACUS PERIPHERALS PVT LTD	1800 22 1988	enquiry@abacusperipherals.com	abacusperipherals.com
ECS	Rashi Peripherals Pvt. Ltd.	(022)61771771	feedback@rptechindia.com	rptechindia.com
Gigabyte	GIGABYTE Technology (India) Pvt. Ltd.	022-40633222	sales@gigabyte.in	gigabyte.in
Intel	NA	NA	NA	intel.com
MSI	ACRO ENGINEERING COMPANY	011-40525645	saini@amigointernational.biz	acrotechindia.com

sition for gamers who want an ROG board, albeit within a limited budget. It has the same red and black coloured design which we have come to adore and the board layout is quite dense as compared to other boards we have seen in this segment. The heatsinks are quite sturdy and well designed, there are dedicate power/reset buttons and the audio section is isolated from the rest of the board. The board also bundles in a mPCIe combo card for on-board WiFi and Bluetooth.

When it came to overclocking, we did not have issues with any board in this test. The overclocking related utilities with the ASUS boards are much more detailed than the ones on the other boards. For instance, the ASUS Ai Suite III has an overclocking setup where the program after overclocking the system tunes other aspects such as fan speeds and energy and so on. Gigabyte have also revamped their overclocking utility which comes with some preset as well as manual overclocking options. We could easily take the Intel Core i4-4770K to 4.6GHz and slightly higher with the ASUS Maximus VI Gene and ASRock boards.

ASRock Z87M Extreme 4 features Home Cloud feature which allows you to remotely access your system and stream content from it. Apart from this it has its proprietary XFast 555 feature which speeds up RAM, LAN and USB speeds and also the Dehumidifier function which dehumidifies a system that hasn't been used for a long time, before fully powering it on. ASUS Maximus VI Gene supports a feature called Sonic Radar which basically gives you a visual direction of where sound is coming from while you are playing a game. You can further prioritise sounds that you want to hear over others – such as bullet shots, footsteps and so on. There are four optimised game presets based on major FPS games and six sound effects are detected in all.

Verdict

In the Under 10k price bracket, the Biostar Hi-Fi Z87X 3D provided a lot of features for its price and offered good value for money. The MSI board comes a close second.

For the 10k to 15k price segment, there was a close fight between the ASRock Z87 Extreme 4 and Gigabyte Z87X-UD3H. Both offer a very good board, wonderful overclocking potential and pertinent utilities. But due to the price differ-

ence, the ASRock Z87 Extreme 4 was awarded the Best Buy. Having said that the Gigabyte Z87X-UD3H is an equally good board, specially if you want on-board Wi-fi.

In the 15k to 20k price segment too two boards finished very close. The ASUS Z87 Pro and MSI Z87 MPower are both good boards, but the MSI Z87 MPower despite coming at a higher price point offered better value proposition than the other and was thus awarded the Best Buy.

The overall Editor's Pick was awarded to ASUS Maximus VI Extreme as this board offers the best features of the lot, multiple ways to overclock the system, an innovative monitoring and tweaking tool in the form of ROG OC Panel and so on. Best Buy was awarded to ASUS Z87 Sabertooth board considering it comes with a five year warranty and is priced lower than the ASUS Z87 Deluxe.

As far as the MicroATX boards go, the Gigabyte Z87M-D3H was awarded the Best Buy due to its lower price point and giving the highest value for money proposition. If money is not an objective for you, but you are keen of getting a microATX form factor board to build a gaming rig, then the ASUS Maximus VI Gene is an interesting board as well. 